

Activist completes Ohio River swim

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Distance swimmer Mimi Hughes, whose 981-mile journey began in Pittsburgh May 22, reached the end of the Ohio River Saturday in Cairo, Ill.

"I am so tired, it's hard to say [how I feel]," she said, laughing. "But the people of the Ohio River Valley have been just wonderful."

Mrs. Hughes, a reading specialist from Tennessee, has undertaken a number of distance swims to raise awareness and funds for various causes. She decided to swim the length of the Ohio River -- reportedly the first person to do so -- in the name of women's education.

The final day went very well, although Mrs. Hughes said she had been warned that the river was "flat," with little current. "I thought I'd be out there for 24 hours because the Mississippi kept backing up [where it meets the Ohio]."

Accompanied by four kayakers, Mrs. Hughes arrived at 5:30 p.m. A crowd met her at Fort Defiance Park in Cairo.